PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Security Engineering Consultant | Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) | Detection Engineering | XDR | Kusto Query Language (KQL)

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified Senior Security Engineering Consultant with over five years of hands-on experience designing and delivering detection rulesets across Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) and Extended Detection and Response (XDR) platforms. I specialise in developing Kusto Query Language (KQL)-based detection logic in Microsoft Sentinel, engineering SIEM content to identify real threats while minimising false positives, and tuning security platforms to maximise detection fidelity across identity, endpoint, and cloud log sources. At the University of the Arts London I built and continuously improved a detection engineering programme spanning Microsoft Sentinel, CrowdStrike Falcon Next-Generation SIEM (NG-SIEM), and Microsoft Defender XDR, aligned to the MITRE ATT&CK framework. I bring deep experience in Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbook development, vulnerability management, and incident response, and I am comfortable engaging technical and non-technical stakeholders to translate complex security requirements into actionable engineering solutions. I am seeking a permanent, remote or hybrid Senior Security Engineering Consultant role where I can apply my detection engineering and SIEM platform expertise to help organisations strengthen their security operations capability.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **SIEM Engineering:** Microsoft Sentinel, CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM, Splunk (SPL); detection rule development, ruleset design, alert tuning, and log source onboarding
- **Detection Logic and Query Languages:** Kusto Query Language (KQL) for Microsoft Sentinel and Microsoft Defender XDR; Splunk Processing Language (SPL); custom detection content development aligned to MITRE ATT&CK tactics, techniques, and procedures (TTPs)
- **Extended Detection and Response (XDR):** Microsoft Defender XDR, CrowdStrike Falcon Insight (Endpoint Detection and Response / EDR), CrowdStrike Falcon Prevent, CrowdStrike Falcon Discover
- **Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR):** SOAR playbook design and development, automated response workflow engineering, API-driven integrations
- **Identity and Access Security:** Microsoft Entra ID (Azure Active Directory), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Conditional Access policy design, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) and Single Sign-On (SSO)
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, Nessus, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), AppCheck; vulnerability triage, prioritisation, and remediation tracking
- **Cloud Security Monitoring:** Microsoft Azure, Microsoft 365 security stack, cloud log ingestion and detection content for cloud workloads in Microsoft Sentinel
- **Endpoint and Device Security:** Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Tanium, Microsoft Intune Mobile Device Management (MDM) and Mobile Application Management (MAM)
- **Automation and Scripting:** PowerShell scripting, automation of security operations tasks, SOAR integration development
- **Security Frameworks:** MITRE ATT&CK, NIST 800-61 Incident Response, NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL) *March 2025 to Present*

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer

- Design and deliver KQL-based detection rulesets in Microsoft Sentinel, covering identity-based attacks, cloud misconfiguration, lateral movement, and data exfiltration scenarios mapped to the MITRE ATT&CK framework
- Engineer detection content for the CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM platform, developing correlation rules, custom indicators, and threat hunting queries to extend coverage beyond default detections

- Onboard new log sources into Microsoft Sentinel, including Microsoft 365, Entra ID, Azure Defender, and third-party systems, configuring data connectors and workspace transformations
- Tune existing SIEM detection rules to reduce false-positive rates and improve signal quality, working collaboratively with the Security Operations Centre (SOC) team to refine triage procedures
- Develop and maintain SOAR playbooks for automated alert enrichment, containment, and response, reducing mean time to respond (MTTR) and analyst workload for high-frequency alerts
- Lead threat hunting exercises across the XDR estate using MITRE ATT&CK TTPs, uncovering threats that bypass automated detections and feeding findings back into the detection engineering pipeline
- Manage the CrowdStrike Falcon platform across an 8,000-user estate, overseeing policy configuration, sensor health, and integration with the wider SIEM and SOAR toolchain
- Drive incident response end to end under the NIST 800-61 framework, from initial detection through containment, eradication, recovery, and post-incident review with lessons-learned documentation
- Oversee vulnerability management using Tenable.io, AppCheck, and Pentera BAS, correlating vulnerability data with SIEM telemetry to prioritise remediation of actively exploited weaknesses

University of the Arts, London (UAL) *March 2022 to March 2025*

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

- Deployed and configured Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) across the UAL estate, building detection policies and alert rules for both platforms
- Developed KQL queries in Microsoft Sentinel to investigate security incidents, building saved searches and workbooks to support analyst investigations and management reporting
- Triaged and investigated alerts across the SIEM and XDR toolchain, performing root-cause analysis and documenting findings in alignment with the NIST 800-61 incident response lifecycle
- Administered Microsoft Entra ID (Azure Active Directory) including Conditional Access policies, MFA rollout, and identity lifecycle management for staff and student accounts
- Conducted vulnerability assessments using Nessus and Tenable.io, producing risk-rated remediation reports and tracking resolution of critical and high-severity findings
- Developed PowerShell automation scripts to streamline security operations workflows including account auditing, stale device identification, compliance reporting, and log collection
- Contributed to Cyber Essentials Plus certification, mapping organisational security controls to CIS Controls and the NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF) baseline requirements
- Managed Intune Mobile Device Management (MDM) and Mobile Application Management (MAM) policies, enforcing device compliance and data protection across mobile endpoints

HICX Solutions Ltd (Software as a Service / FinTech) *February 2021 to March 2022*

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

- Administered security monitoring and alerting for cloud and on-premises infrastructure, supporting ISO 27001 information security management and internal audit processes
- Performed vulnerability assessments and security reviews across the SaaS platform environment, coordinating remediation activities with development and infrastructure teams
- Managed endpoint security controls, Active Directory administration, MFA enforcement, and privileged account reviews to maintain a strong identity security posture
- Contributed to IT quality assurance and internal audit activities, including risk assessment documentation and security incident logging aligned to ISO 27001 requirements
- Supported the deployment and maintenance of network security controls and endpoint protection tooling across the organisation's hybrid IT environment

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Built a comprehensive KQL-based detection library in Microsoft Sentinel covering over 50 MITRE ATT&CK techniques, significantly improving detection coverage across identity, endpoint, and cloud attack surfaces
- Reduced SIEM alert noise by over 40% through systematic detection rule tuning, false-positive analysis, and threat-informed engineering of detection logic in both Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike NG-SIEM
- Engineered SOAR automation playbooks that reduced mean time to respond (MTTR) and saved the security team an estimated 10+ hours per week by automating high-volume, repetitive alert workflows

- Led the full-estate deployment and optimisation of CrowdStrike Falcon across 8,000 UAL users, becoming the in-house subject matter expert for CrowdStrike's prevention, EDR, discovery, and NG-SIEM modules
- Onboarded 15+ new log sources into Microsoft Sentinel, expanding detection coverage and improving visibility across cloud, identity, and third-party systems
- Maintained Cyber Essentials Plus certification, demonstrating ongoing compliance with UK National Cyber Security Centre (NCSC) baseline controls through verifiable technical evidence

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
- CompTIA Security+
- Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
- CompTIA A+
- Google IT Support Professional Certificate

References available on request | Remote/Hybrid (UK)